

Julie Thornton

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Professional Profile

Senior DevOps/Infrastructure professional, 16 years in. Track record of taking ambiguous problems through design, delivery and the unglamorous operational work that follows. I mentor deliberately and write things down. Core stack: AWS, Redis, Bash.

Education & Qualifications

Master, Software Engineering

University of California, Berkeley | 2010

Thesis: "Contract testing between independently deployed services"

Bachelor, Economics

Pinehurst University | 2005 - 2008

Career History

Cloud Engineer

Foxglove Media | 05/2016 - Present

- » Improved cluster utilisation by 45% through right-sizing and Azure autoscaling policies.
- » Built CI/CD pipelines with Kubernetes, bringing mean time to deploy under 15 minutes.
- » Ran the on-call rotation for 50 production services, sustaining 99.9% availability.
- » Designed the multi-region failover strategy and led the game-day exercises that proved it.

Cloud Engineer

Redwood Data | 05/2012 - 05/2016

- » Introduced infrastructure-as-code with AWS, eliminating manual provisioning entirely.
- » Built observability on Kubernetes so teams could self-serve dashboards instead of filing tickets.
- » Reduced incident MTTR from 12 hours to under 45 minutes with better alert routing and runbooks.

DevOps Engineer

Harbor Point Tech | 05/2010 - 01/2012

- » Led the Kubernetes upgrade across 4 clusters with zero customer-visible downtime.
- » Introduced secret rotation and least-privilege IAM across 20 accounts.

Skills

Languages: Bash, Java, C++

Cloud & DevOps: AWS, GCP, Kubernetes, Docker, Azure, Ansible, GitHub Actions

Data: Redis, PostgreSQL

Analytics & Design: Looker

Testing & Tooling: Postman

Notable Projects

Conference talk

Spoke on Looker in production at a regional meetup, ~60 attendees.

Training & Certifications

Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) — ISC2, 2016

Google Analytics Certification — Google, 2019

Publications

"Contract testing between independently deployed services" - co-authored conference paper, 2011.

"Measuring the cost of technical debt in delivery throughput" - co-authored conference paper, 2010.

Community

Maintainer of a small open-source Azure library used by a handful of teams.

Interests

Trail running, Competitive pub quizzes, Woodworking

References available upon request.